ICAO Portrait Standards: Specifications for Digital Facial Images in Travel Documents

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1. Pose, Illumination and Background

The subject portrait must be taken facing forward with a neutral facial expression, mouth closed, and eyes open and clearly visible. Background must be plain, uniform, and light-coloured (white or light grey). Shadows across face or background are unacceptable. Eyeglasses must not have tinted lenses or heavy frames obscuring pupils.

2. Head Size and Geometry Ratios

The vertical distance from chin to crown must occupy between 70% and 80% of the total image height. The interpupillary distance must be at least 90 pixels for automated biometric matching. Compression artifacts (JPEG blocking) must not exceed standard Q=80 threshold.